1. Monitoring progress and efficacy of strategic and long-term policy and program frameworks and initiatives to help innovative improvements, including necessary mid-course corrections; and

2. Actively monitoring and evaluating the implementation of programs and initiatives, including the identification of the needed resources so as to strengthen the probability of success and scope of delivery.

The DMEO's mandate also expands to technical advisory to States, under NITI Aayog's mandate of cooperative and competitive federalism. It's institutional positioning gives the organization convening power to create a platform for monitoring and evaluation advancement in the country.

The Headquarters of DMEO is in NITI Aayog, New Delhi. Till 2017, the DMEO had 15 Regional Offices known as Regional Development Monitoring and Evaluation Offices (RDMEOs). The RDMEOs conducted field surveys and data/information collection work for evaluation studies, and they also played an important role in promoting cooperative federalism by their interaction with the States and UT administrations. However, keeping in view the changed functional requirements, they were closed in 2017 and the staff were transferred to DMEO Headquarters in New Delhi.

Erstwhile Planning Commission

The erstwhile Planning Commission was established in March 1950 by an executive resolution of the Government of India, (i.e., the Union Cabinet) on the recommendation of the Advisory Planning Board constituted in 1946, under the chairmanship of K.C. Neogi. Thus, the erstwhile Planning Commission was neither a constitutional body nor a statutory body. In India, it was the supreme organ of planning for social and economic development.

Functions The functions of the erstwhile Planning Commission included the following:

1. To make an assessment of material, capital and human resources of the country, and investigate the possibilities of augmenting them.

2. To formulate a plan for the most effective and balanced utilisation of the country's resources.

3. To determine priorities and to define the stages in which the plan should be carried out.

4. To indicate the factors that retard economic development.

5. To determine the nature of the machinery required for successful implementation of the plan in each stage.

6. To appraise, from time to time, the progress achieved in execution of the plan and to recommend necessary adjustments.

7. To make appropriate recommendations for facilitating the discharge of its duties, or on a matter referred to it for advice by Central or state governments.

It should be noted that the erstwhile Planning Commission was only a staff agency—an advisory body and had no executive responsibility. It was not responsible for taking and implementing decisions. This responsibility rested with the Central and State Governments.